CSIS JAPAN CHAIR

Japan Daily Brief

Sunday, October 11, 2026

1,687 words · 7 min read

RE: Rubio-Motegi ICC call · BOJ rate hike deliberations · GCAP Japan design center · Okinawa curfew · UN 'enemy clause' push

NIKKEI 225	USD/JPY	BRENT	BOJ RATE
69,030.92	158.25	$104.72	1.25%
▼ -1.31%	▲ +0.32%	▲ +4.12%	

TOP STORIES

ALLIANCE

Rubio cites ‘necessity’ of U.S. sanctions on ICC in call with Japanese counterpart

Secretary of State **Marco Rubio** told Foreign Minister **Toshimitsu Motegi** that US sanctions on the International Criminal Court were a 'necessity' in a phone call reported today, a direct rebuttal to Japan's formal objections. The ICC's legislative body has separately demanded the 'immediate revocation' of the sanctions, and Prime Minister **Sanae Takaichi** has previously described them as 'incompatible with Japan's position,' placing Tokyo in the difficult position of publicly opposing a core ally's unilateral action against an institution to which Japan is a founding party.

THE JAPAN TIMES

CHINA-JAPAN

Japan PM's call at UN for cutting WWII 'enemy' clause may roil China ties

Prime Minister **Sanae Takaichi** is calling for deletion of World War II 'enemy state' clauses from the UN Charter, per Kyodo reporting via Mainichi. The move spotlights Japan's push for a larger institutional role at the UN but directly antagonizes Beijing, which has used the clauses as a legal argument and whose relationship with Tokyo is already strained over Takaichi's Taiwan-related remarks and the ongoing protocol-title dispute.

MAINICHI

DEFENSE

UK-Japan-Italy fighter plans Japan design center with '1,000' staff

The UK-Japan-Italy Global Combat Air Programme plans to establish a Japan-based design center with roughly *1,000* staff, per Nikkei Asia. The center would anchor Japan's industrial contribution to the next-generation fighter, a flagship defense-industrial cooperation project under the Takaichi government's expanded defense buildup.

NIKKEI ASIA

ALLIANCE

Rubio pledges US cooperation in Okinawa murder case

Secretary of State **Marco Rubio** pledged US cooperation in the investigation of the murder of a woman linked to a US Marine, per Reuters, following earlier formal protests from Prime Minister Takaichi to Washington. NHK World reported off-base areas in Okinawa were quiet under the US military curfew imposed in response to the case.

REUTERS

ALLIANCE

26% in Japan see U.S. as biggest threat to world peace: survey

A new survey reported by The Japan Times finds *26%* of Japanese respondents identify the United States as the biggest threat to world peace — a 9.3 percentage-point rise from fiscal 2025 and up from 6.6% in fiscal 2024. The sharp two-year acceleration coincides with US sanctions on the ICC, trade pressure, and the Okinawa Marine murder case.

THE JAPAN TIMES

ECONOMY-BOJ

Japan PM Takaichi works to shed reflationist label on market, US pressure

Prime Minister **Sanae Takaichi** is actively distancing herself from the reflationary economic identity she carried into office, according to Nikkei Asia, amid market pressure over the yen and US scrutiny of Japan's fiscal stance. Mainichi separately reported Takaichi rejected the 'reflationary' label for her economic policies at a press conference.

NIKKEI ASIA

STAT OF THE DAY

26%

Japanese public who see the US as the biggest threat to world peace

The rate rose 9.3 percentage points from the prior fiscal 2025 survey and stood at just 6.6% in fiscal 2024, according to a new survey reported by The Japan Times.

26% in Japan see U.S. as biggest threat to world peace: survey — Japan Times

JAPANESE GOVERNMENT

KANTEI/PM · CABINET · MOFA · MOD · METI · MOF · BOJ · DIET · SUNDAY, OCTOBER 11, 2026

PM Watch: PM appeared today · 0 day(s) since last confirmed appearance — Prime Minister **Sanae Takaichi** has been publicly active on the ICC sanctions dispute (declaring them 'incompatible with Japan's position'), with Foreign Minister Motegi conducting a follow-up call with Rubio today at her direction; Takaichi also pushed at the UN for deletion of WWII 'enemy state' clauses from the UN Charter.

外務省 · MINISTRY OF FOREIGN AFFAIRS · *Toshimitsu Motegi, Foreign Minister*

Motegi conveys Japan's ICC position to Rubio in phone call; Rubio cites 'necessity'

Foreign Minister **Toshimitsu Motegi** held a telephone call with US Secretary of State **Marco Rubio** to convey Japan's opposition to US sanctions on the International Criminal Court. Rubio told Motegi the sanctions were a 'necessity,' while the ICC's legislative body separately demanded their 'immediate revocation' and urged the international community to 'stand firm.' Prime Minister **Sanae Takaichi** had previously declared the sanctions 'incompatible with Japan's position.'

→ NHK ↗

DIET SESSIONS / LDP

CABINET / DIET

Government submits food consumption tax cut bill; aims for passage this Diet session

The Takaichi Cabinet submitted the consumption tax reduction bill to the Diet and is targeting passage within the current extraordinary session. An external food-industry group warned the cuts will have a greater impact on restaurants and daily-necessity shops than on other sectors.

LDP

Former PM Ishiba criticizes Agriculture Minister Yana controversy as 'suspicious for those in politics'

Former Prime Minister **Shigeru Ishiba** publicly condemned the Agriculture Minister Yana controversy, stating it was 'suspicious for those in politics,' adding pressure on Prime Minister Takaichi who has declined opposition calls to dismiss the minister.

● PUBLIC SENTIMENT & APPROVAL POLLING

POLLSTER	APPROVE	DISAPPROVE
JNN · Oct 4, 2026	**63%**	**33.9%**
Asahi · Sep 28, 2026	**51%**	**33%**
ANN · Sep 23, 2026	**58.3%**	**27.6%**
Kyodo · Sep 23, 2026	**53.4%**	**30.9%**
Nikkei · Sep 5, 2026 · **36d ago**	**62%**	**33%**
Yomiuri · Sep 19, 2026 · **22d ago**	**59%**	**30%**
FNN · Sep 15, 2026 · **26d ago**	**61.6%**	**32.2%**
NHK · Sep 10, 2026 · **31d ago**	**52.8%**	**30.8%**

Discourse: Former PM Shigeru Ishiba publicly criticized the Agriculture Minister Yana controversy as 'suspicious for those in politics,' compounding opposition pressure on PM Takaichi who has refused to dismiss the minister.

Poll tracker: **Observing Japan approval-rating aggregator →**

BUSINESS & ECONOMY

MANUFACTURING · MAINICHI · KAWASAKI HEAVY INDUSTRIES

Kawasaki Heavy Industries targets ¥1 trillion ($6.3 billion) in defense sales by mid-2030s

Kawasaki Heavy Industries plans to grow its defense sales to *¥1 trillion* ($6.3 billion) or more in the mid-2030s, driven by Japan's defense buildup. The target reflects a substantial expansion from current defense revenues as Japan's five-year defense spending plan drives domestic procurement.

MANUFACTURING · NIKKEI ASIA · THALES

French defense contractor Thales to open maintenance base in Japan

France's Thales plans to open a Japan-based maintenance facility, per Nikkei Asia, expanding the footprint of European defense firms in Japan as Tokyo diversifies its defense-industrial partnerships beyond the United States. No financial terms or timeline were specified in the available report.

MACRO · MAINICHI

Opinion: Japan GDP annualized growth revised to 1.4%; strategic investment flagged as key to productivity

Revised Cabinet Office data shows Japan's real GDP expanded at an annualized *1.4%*, per Kyodo. The piece argues current growth lacks structural momentum and calls for targeted strategic investment to drive productivity gains.

TECH · MAINICHI · EAST JAPAN RAILWAY, JR EAST

JR East to launch 'teppay' digital payment service October 20

East Japan Railway will launch its new digital payment platform 'teppay' on October 20, entering competition in Japan's expanding cashless payments sector. The move reflects rail operators' push to build revenue streams beyond fares.

MANUFACTURING · NIKKEI ASIA · KOBE STEEL

Kobe Steel eyes India M&A to expand compressor production

Kobe Steel is considering acquisitions in India to scale up compressor manufacturing, per a company executive quoted by Nikkei Asia. The move is part of Japan's broader industrial push into India amid strengthening bilateral ties.

REGIONAL PRESSURE WATCH

Low — 5 items (Japanese government: 3, adversary signal: 2)

CHINA

Japan lodged a formal complaint with Beijing over China's deliberate omission of Prime Minister Takaichi's title — referring to her as 'Sanae Takaichi' without the prime-ministerial designation — continuing a documented protocol-slight campaign. Japan Times commentary today also frames the Japan-China relationship through the lens of 'weaponized interdependence,' noting that booming bilateral trade coexists with rising strategic tensions over Taiwan remarks, the APEC summit uncertainty, and the UN 'enemy clause' push.

NORTH KOREA

An expert analysis reported via Inquirer.net assesses North Korea as capable of overwhelming US homeland missile defense, a finding with direct implications for Japan's extended deterrence calculus. No new DPRK launch or EEZ splashdown was reported today.

Senkaku / ECS: No new China Coast Guard intrusion into Senkaku territorial waters is reported in today's Tier 1 or Tier 4 data; the near-daily CCG patrol pattern documented in the persistent tracker continues as baseline.

> *"Genuine respect lies in facing history."*
>
> Chinese Foreign Ministry (attributed in prior reporting; carried in today's tracker context) · Japan lodges formal complaint with China for calling Prime Minister Sanae Takaichi Sanae Takaichi — SoraNews24

Bottom line: Beijing's protocol-title campaign against Takaichi continues as the dominant China-Japan friction signal today, overlapping with a UN Charter dispute; the Rubio-Motegi ICC call is the day's sharpest bilateral friction point, with Japan publicly opposing a US policy action while needing alliance cohesion on China and DPRK.

U.S.-JAPAN RELATIONS

ALLIANCE · US DEPARTMENT OF STATE

State Department readout: Rubio call with Motegi covers ICC sanctions and Okinawa murder case

The US Department of State issued a formal readout of Secretary **Marco Rubio**'s call with Foreign Minister **Toshimitsu Motegi**, covering both US ICC sanctions — where Rubio cited 'necessity' — and the murder of a woman linked to a US Marine in Okinawa, where Rubio offered condolences and pledged cooperation. The dual-issue call encapsulates the two most acute bilateral friction points on this date.

INDO-PACIFIC PARTNERS

SOUTHEAST ASIA · NIKKEI ASIA

Vietnam opens 'landmark' piracy prosecution protecting Japanese intellectual property

Vietnam has opened what Nikkei Asia describes as a 'landmark' prosecution for piracy of Japanese intellectual property, marking a concrete enforcement step in the bilateral relationship. The case reflects growing IP-protection cooperation between Tokyo and Hanoi as Japan increases investment in Vietnam.

KOREA-JAPAN · UPI

Japan seeks Trump's help arranging a summit with Kim Jong Un

Japan is seeking US assistance in arranging a direct summit between Prime Minister **Sanae Takaichi** and North Korean leader Kim Jong Un, per UPI. The request reflects Tokyo's longstanding abductee agenda and its calculation that Washington's diplomatic channel to Pyongyang is the most viable avenue for a bilateral approach.

UPCOMING

Oct 15 — **Japan-Vietnam summit under discussion for November in Tokyo**

Japan is eyeing a November summit with Vietnam in Tokyo focused on energy and security, per Mainichi reporting. No confirmed date has been announced.

Oct 18 — **Kusatsu city mayoral election (Shiga Prefecture) — voting day**

Four candidates are contesting the Kusatsu city mayoral election, the first in a decade, with voting scheduled for October 18.

Oct 20 — **JR East launches 'teppay' digital payment service**

East Japan Railway will launch its new digital payment service, 'teppay,' on October 20, competing in Japan's expanding digital payments market.

Nov 1 — **APEC summit window — Xi-Takaichi bilateral uncertain**

Beijing has not confirmed whether Xi Jinping will hold a bilateral with Prime Minister Takaichi at APEC; China has conditioned dialogue on resolution of Takaichi's Taiwan-related remarks. Timing is approximate.

Nov 1

Japan-Vietnam summit (Tokyo) — planning stage

Japan is working to arrange a bilateral summit with Vietnam in November in Tokyo, covering energy cooperation and security; a date has not been formally set.

CSIS Japan Chair

JAPAN DAILY BRIEF

Washington, D.C.

Read online · Past issues

You are receiving the Japan Daily Brief as a member of the CSIS Japan Chair distribution list.

This newsletter is automatically generated, so it may contain errors. Please check all information and sources before citing. To report errors or other issues, please contact Deirdre Martin at dmartin@csis.org.

generated 7:05 AM ET

↑ BACK TO TOP

© 2026 Center for Strategic and International Studies